

**UNIT
1**

PRESENT TENSE

UNIT 1 PRESENT TENSE

Present Simple Tense

Type of Tense	Structure	Example
Affirmative	Sub + V1 + Object	She writes a letter. They play football.
Negative	Subject + do/does + not + V1 + object	She doesn't write a letter. They don't play football.
Question	Do/Does + Subject + V1 + object?	Does she write a letter? Do they play football?
Negative Question	Do/Does + Subject + not + V1 + object?	Don't you like ice cream? Don't they study hard?

Imperative

Affirmative	Verb (base form) + Rest of sentence	Play cricket.
Negative	Don't + Verb (base form)	Don't play cricket.

State verbs – Uses of "Is, Am, Are" & Has/Have

Affirmative	Negative	Questions	Negative Question
Subject + is/am/are + complement.	Subject + is/am/are + not + complement	Is/am/are + subject + complement?	Is/am/are + sub + not + complement?
Examples: She is a teacher. I am a student. We are friends.	Examples: She isn't a doctor. I'm not at home. They aren't my friends.	Examples: Is she a doctor? Am I late? Are you ready?	Examples: Isn't she a doctor? Aren't we ready?
HAS/HAVE	Negative Structure	Questions Structure	Negative Question
Subject + has/have + complement	Subject + do/does + not + have + complement.	Do/Does + subject + have + complement?	Don't/Doesn't + subject + have + complement?
Examples: I have a book. She has a pencil.	Examples: I don't have a book. She doesn't have a pencil.	Examples: Do I have a book? Does she have a pencil?	Examples: Don't I have a book? Doesn't she have a pencil?

Present Continuous Tense

Affirmative	Subject + is/am/are + verb (-ing)	I'm reading a book. She is playing football. They are studying .
Negative	Subject + is/am/are + not + verb (-ing)	I'm not eating right now. He isn't watching TV. We aren't going to school today.
Question	Is/Am/Are + subject + verb (-ing)?	Is she playing cricket? Are they studying ? Am I doing it correctly?

Negative Question	Is/Are/Am + not + subject + verb (-ing)?	Isn't she watching TV? Aren't they studying now?
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Present Perfect Tense

Affirmative	Subject + has/have + past participle (3rd form)	She has eaten lunch. We have finished homework.
Negative	Subject + hasn't/haven't + past participle	She hasn't eaten lunch. We haven't finished homework.
Question	Has/Have + subject + past participle?	Has she eaten lunch? Have you finished homework?
Negative Question	Hasn't/Haven't + subject + past participle?	Hasn't she eaten lunch? Haven't you finished homework?

Present Perfect State for Existence or Condition (verb "to be")

Affirmative	Negative	Questions	Negative Question
Subject + has/have + been + noun/adjective/place.	Subject + has/have + not + been + noun/adjective/place.	Has/Have + subject + been + noun/adjective/place?	Hasn't/Haven't + subject + been + noun/adjective/place?
Examples: She has been happy. They have been helpful.	Examples: She hasn't been happy. They haven't been helpful.	Examples: Has she been happy? Have they been helpful?	Examples: Hasn't she been happy? Haven't they been helpful?

Present Perfect Continuous Tense

Affirmative	Subject + has/have + been + verb(-ing)	I have been practising guitar for two hours. She has been running since morning.
Negative	Subject + has/have + not + been + verb(-ing)	I haven't been practising guitar for two hours. She hasn't been running since morning.
Question	Has/Have + subject + been + verb(-ing)+?	Have I been practising guitar for two hours? Has she been running since morning?
Negative Question	Hasn't/Haven't + subject + been + verb(-ing)+?	Haven't I been practising guitar for two hours? Hasn't she been running since morning?

Present Simple is used: • for permanent situations or states. She is happy. He works in a hospital.	Present Continuous is used for: • temporary situations. She is working in Paris this week.
• for general truths and laws of nature. Water boils at 100°C.	• changing or developing situations. The world is getting taller and taller.
• for repeated/habitual actions (especially with adverbs of frequency: often, usually, always, etc.). He always gets up at seven. (Here "always" means every day.)	• frequently repeated actions with always, constantly, etc., expressing annoyance or criticism. He is always asking stupid question (here always mean constantly)
• for timetables/schedules, (future meaning). The plane leaves at 3:30.	• action happening at or around the moment of speaking The baby is sleeping at the moment
	• fixed arrangements in the near future or be + going + to (gonna). I'm seeing Zain tonight. OR I'm going to (gonna) see Zain tonight.
Present Perfect is used for: • recently completed actions whose results are visible in the present. He has cut his finger (and it is bleeding).	Present Perfect Continuous is used: • for actions that started in the past and are still going on in the present. He has been washing his bike for an hour. (He started an hour ago and he's still washing it.)
• actions that started in the past up to the present with emphasis on the result, not on the time. She has been a doctor for ten years.	• for past actions of certain duration having visible results or effects in the present. He has been fighting. That's why he's got a black eye.

- **actions which happened within a specific time period which is not over at the time of speaking. We use expressions such as today, this morning/evening /week/month, etc.**

He **has read** three novels this week.
(The time period – this week – is not over yet. He may read another.

- **Present Perfect Continuous is normally used with for, since or how long to put emphasis on duration.**

She **has been waiting** since 4 o'clock.

Time expression used with:

Present Simple

every day/week/month/year, usually, sometimes, always, rarely, never, often, in the morning/evening/afternoon, at night, on Mondays, etc.

Present Continuous

now, at the moment, at present, nowadays, today, tonight, always, still, etc.

Present Perfect & Present Perfect Continuous

just, ever, never, already, yet (negatives & questions), always, how long, so far, since, for, recently, since + date, from (a starting point in the past), for (over a period of time), today, this week/month, etc.

For and **since** are usually used with **Present Perfect Continuous** to emphasize the duration of an action.

1 PRESENT CONTINUOUS (I AM DOING)

Exercise: 1

What's happening in the pictures? Choose from these verbs:

cross hide scratch take — tie wave



1. She's taking a picture.

2. He _____ a shoelace.

3. _____ the road.

4. _____ his head.
5. _____ behind a tree.
6. _____ to somebody.

Exercise: 2

The sentences on the right follow those on the left. Which sentence goes with which?

1. Please don't make so much noise.	a. I'm getting hungry.	
2. We need to leave soon.	b. They're lying.	
3. I don't have anywhere to live right now.	c. It's starting to rain.	
4. I need to eat something soon.	d. They're trying to sell it.	
5. They don't need their car anymore.	e. It's getting late.	
6. Things are not so good at work.	f. I'm trying to work.	
7. It isn't true what they say.	g. I'm staying with friends.	
8. We're going to get wet.	h. The company is losing money.	

Exercise: 3

Write questions. Use the present continuous.

1. What's all that noise? What's happening? (what / happen?)
2. What's the matter? _____ (why / you / cry?)
3. Where's your mother? _____ (she / work / today?)
4. I haven't seen you for ages. _____
(what / you / do / these days?)

5. Sofia is a student. _____ (what / she / study?)

6. Who are those people? _____ (what / they / do?)

7. I heard you started a new job. _____ (you / enjoy / it?)

8. We're not in a hurry. _____ (why / you / walk / so fast?)

Exercise: 4

Put the verb into the correct form, positive (I'm doing etc.) or negative (I'm not doing etc.).

1. Please don't make so much noise. *I'm trying* (I try) to work.

2. Let's go out now. *It isn't raining.* (it / rain) anymore.

3. You can turn off the radio. _____ (I / listen) to it.

4. Ali phoned last night. He's on holiday with friends. _____ (he / have) a great time and doesn't want to come back.

5. Zain started evening classes recently. _____ (He / learn) Japanese.

6. Ali and Sarah had an argument and now _____ (they / speak) to one another.

7. The situation is already very bad and now _____ (it / get) worse.

8. Ali _____ (work) today. He's taken the day off.

9. _____ (I / look) for Sophie. Do you know where she is?

10. The washing machine has been repaired. _____
_____ (It / work) now.

11. My parents live in London. They _____
(move) to a new flat next month.

12. The population of the world _____
(increase) very fast.

2 PRESENT SIMPLE (I DO)

Exercise: 1

Complete the sentences using the following verbs:

cause(s) close(s) connect(s) go(es) live(s)
~~— speak(s) —~~ take(s)

1. Tanya speaks German very well.
2. Ali and Zain _____ to the same school.
3. Bad driving _____ many accidents.
4. The museum _____ at 4 o'clock on Sundays.
5. My parents _____ in a very small flat.
6. The Olympic Games _____ place every four years.
7. The Panama Canal _____ the Atlantic and Pacific oceans.

Exercise: 2

Put the verb into the correct form.

1. Sarah doesn't drink (not/ drink) tea very often.
2. What time _____ (the banks/ close) here?
3. I have a car, but I _____ (not/ use) it much.

4. Where _____ (Maria / come) from? Is she Spanish?
5. 'What _____ (you / do)?' 'I'm an electrician.'
6. Look at this sentence. What _____ (this word / mean)?
7. David isn't very fit. He _____ (not / do) any sport.
8. It _____ (take) me an hour to get to work in the morning.
How long _____ (it / take) you?

Exercise: 3

Complete the sentences using these verbs. Sometimes you need the negative.

believe eat flow ~~go~~ ~~grow~~ make rise
 tell translate

1. The Earth goes round the Sun.
2. Rice doesn't grow in cold climates.
3. The Sun _____ in the east.
4. Bees _____ honey.
5. Vegetarians _____ meat.
6. An atheist _____ in God.
7. An interpreter _____ from one language into another.
8. Liars are people who _____ the truth.
9. The River Amazon _____ into the Atlantic Ocean.

Exercise: 4

You ask Rida questions about herself and her family. Write the questions.

1. You know that Rida plays tennis. You want to know how often.

Ask her. How often do you play tennis?

2. Perhaps Rida's sister plays tennis too. You want to know.

Ask Rida. _____ your sister _____?

3. You know that Rida goes to the cinema a lot. You want to know how often.

Ask her. _____?

4. You know that Rida's brother works. You want to know what he does.

Ask Rida. _____?

5. You're not sure whether Rida speaks English. You want to know.

Ask her. _____?

6. You don't know where Rida's grandparents live. You want to know.

Ask Rida. _____?

Exercise: 5

Complete using the following:

I agree I apologise I insist I promise I recommend
~~I suggest~~

1. Mr. Evans is not in the office today. *I suggest* you try calling him tomorrow.

2. I won't tell anybody what you said _____.

3. (in a restaurant) You must let me pay for the meal. _____.

4. _____ for what I said. I shouldn't have said it.

5. The new restaurant in Baker Street is very good. _____ it.

6. I think you're absolutely right. _____ with you.

3

PRESENT CONTINUOUS AND PRESENT SIMPLE 1 (I AM DOING AND I DO)

Exercise: 1

Are the underlined verbs OK? Correct them where necessary.

1. Water boils at 100 degrees Celsius. *OK*

2. How often are you going to the cinema? *do you go*

3. Ali tries to find a job, but he hasn't had any luck yet. _____

4. Martina is phoning her mother every day. _____

5. The moon goes round the earth in about 27 days. _____

6. Can you hear those people? What do they talk about? _____

7. What do you do in your spare time? _____
8. Sarah is a vegetarian. She doesn't eat meat. _____
9. I must go now. It gets late. _____
10. 'Come on! It's time to leave.' 'OK, I come.' _____
11. Ali is never late. He's always starting work on time. _____
12. They don't get on well. They're always arguing. _____

Exercise: 2

Put the verb into the correct form, present continuous or present simple.

1. a. I usually get (I / usually / get) hungry in the afternoon.
b. I'm getting (I / get) hungry. Let's go and eat something.
2. a. _____ (you / listen) to the radio?
b. _____ (you / listen) to the radio a lot? 'No, not very often.'
3. a. The River Nile _____ (flow) into the Mediterranean.
b. The river _____ (flow) very fast today – much faster than usual.
4. a. I'm not very active. _____ (I / not / do) any sport.
b. What _____ (you / usually / do) at weekends?
5. a. Ayesha is in New York right now. _____ (She / stay) at the Park Hotel.
b. _____ (She / always / stay) there when she's in New York.

Exercise: 3

Finish B's sentences. Use always -ing.

1. A: I've lost my keys again.
B: Not again! You're always losing your keys.
2. A: The car has broken down again.

B: That car is useless.

It _____

3. A: Look! You've made the same mistake again.

B: Oh no, not again! I

4. A: Oh, I left my phone at home again.

B: Typical!

4

PRESENT CONTINUOUS AND PRESENT SIMPLE 2 (I AM DOING AND I DO)

➤ We use continuous forms (**I'm waiting, it's raining, etc.**) for actions and happenings that have started but are not finished.

Some verbs (for example, **know** and **like**) are not normally used in this way. We don't say 'I am knowing,' 'they are liking'. We say 'I **know**,' 'they **like**'.

The following verbs are not normally used in the present continuous:

like	want	need	prefer
know	realise	understand	recognise
believe	suppose	remember	recognise
belong	fit	contain	consist
seem			

Examples:

- I'm hungry. I **want** something to eat. (not I'm wanting)
- **Do** you **understand** what I **mean**?
- Sarah **doesn't seem** very happy right now.

➤ We normally use the present simple (not continuous) with **see/hear/smell/taste/look/feel**.

- **Do** you **see** that man over there? (not are you seeing)
- The room **smells**. Let's open a window.
- This soup **doesn't taste** very good.

You can use the present simple or continuous to say how somebody **looks** or **feels** now:

- You **look** well today. or You're **looking** well today.
 - How **do** you **feel** now? or How **are** you **feeling** now?
- but:
- I usually **feel** tired in the morning. (not I'm usually feeling)

➤ **am/is/are being**

You can say **he's being, you're being,** etc. to say how somebody is behaving now:

- I can't understand why **he's being** so selfish. He isn't usually like that. (**being** selfish = behaving selfishly now)
- 'The path is icy. Don't slip.' 'Don't worry. **I'm being** very careful.'

Compare:

- He never thinks about other people. He's very selfish.
(= he is selfish generally, not only now)
- I don't like to take risks. **I'm** a very careful person.
We use **am/is/are being** to say how a person is behaving (= doing something they can control) now. It is not usually possible in other situations:
- Sam **is** ill. (not is being ill)
- **Are** you tired? (not are you being tired)

Exercise: 1

Put the verb into the correct form, present continuous or present simple.

1. Are you hungry? Do you want (you / want) something to eat?
2. Ali says he's 90 years old, but nobody _____
(believe) him.
3. She told me her name, but _____ (I / not / remember) it now.
4. Don't put the dictionary away. _____ (I / use) it.
5. Don't put the dictionary away. _____ (I / need) it.
6. Air _____ (consist) mainly of nitrogen and oxygen.
7. Who is that man? What _____ (he / want)?
8. Who is that man? Why _____ (he / look) at us?

9. Who is that man? _____ (you / recognise) him?
10. _____ (I / think) of selling my car. Would you be interested in buying it?
11. I can't make up my mind. What _____ (you / think) I should do?
12. Zain wasn't well earlier, but _____ (he / seem) OK now.

Exercise: 2

Complete the sentences. Use **is/are being** (continuous) or **is/are** (simple).

1. I can't understand why he's being so selfish. He isn't usually like that.
2. You'll like Sophia when you meet her. She ... very nice.
3. Sarah _____ very nice to me at the moment. I wonder why.
4. They _____ very happy. They've just got married.
5. You're normally very patient, so why _____ so unreasonable about waiting ten more minutes?
6. Would you like something to eat? _____ hungry?

5

I'M GOING TO (DO)

A) I am going to do something = I have already decided to do it, I intend to do it. We can also use **I am going to do** something just like present continuous for future arrangements.

- "Are you **going to eat** anything?"
"No, I'm not hungry."
- **A:** I hear Sarah won the lottery. What is she **going to do** with the money?
 - She's **going to buy** a new car.
- I'm just **going to make** a quick phone call. Can you wait for me?
- This cheese smells horrible. I'm not **going to eat it**.

B) I **was going** to do something = I intended to do it, but didn't do it:

- We **were going to travel** by train, but then we decided to drive instead.
- I **was** just **going to cross** the road when somebody shouted "Stop!"

You can say that 'something **was going to happen**' (but didn't happen):

- I thought it **was going to rain**, but it didn't.

Exercise: 1

Write questions with going to.

1. Your friend has won some money. You ask:

(what / do?) What are you going to do with it?

2. Your friend is going to a wedding next week. You ask:

(what / wear?) _____

3. Your friend has just bought a new table. You ask:

(where / put?) _____

4. Your friend has decided to have a party. You ask:

(who / invite?) _____

5. Your friend has bought some fish for dinner. You ask:

(how / cook?) _____

Exercise: 2

Complete the sentences using I'm going to / I'm not going to. Choose from:

complain	learn	run	say	try	wash	not/accept
		not/eat		not/tell		

1. This cheese smells horrible. I'm not going to eat it.

2. I haven't been trying hard enough. From now _____
harder.

3. I have to make a speech tomorrow, but I don't know what _____
_____.

4. 'The car is very dirty.' 'I know, _____ it.'

5. I've been offered a job, _____ it. The pay is too low.

6. _____ a language, but I haven't decided yet which one.

7. One day _____ in a marathon. It's my ambition.

8. The food in this restaurant is awful. _____.
9. Ali doesn't need to know what happened, so _____ him.

Exercise: 3

What is going to happen in these situations? Use the words in brackets.

1. There are a lot of black clouds in the sky. (rain) *It's going to rain.*
2. It is 8.30. Ali is leaving home. He has to be at work at 8.45, but the journey takes 30 minutes. (late) He _____
3. There is a hole in the bottom of the boat. A lot of water is coming in through the hole. (sink) The boat _____
4. Sami and Ali are driving. The tank is nearly empty. It's a long way to the nearest petrol station. (run out) They _____
5. Sarah's car was badly damaged in an accident. Now it has to be repaired. (cost a lot) It _____ to repair the car.

6

PRESENT PERFECT 1 (I HAVE DONE AND I DID)

➤ When we use the present perfect, there is a connection with now. The action in the past has a result now:

- Zain **has lost** his key. (= he doesn't have it now)
- He told me his name, but **I've forgotten** it. (= I can't remember it now)
- Sarah is still here. She **hasn't gone** out. (= she is here now)
- I can't find my bag. **Have** you **seen** it? (= do you know where it is now?)

Compare **gone (to)** and **been (to)**:

- Ali is on holiday. He **has gone** to Italy. (= he is there now or on his way there)
- Hania is back home now. She **has been** to Italy. (= she has now come back)

➤ You can use the present perfect with just, already, yet, and so far.

- **Just** = a short time ago:

- "Are you hungry?" "No, I've just had lunch."
- Hello. Have you just arrived?

- **Already** = sooner than expected:

- "Don't forget to pay the bill." "I've already paid it."
- "What time is Ali leaving?" "He's already left."

• **Yet/ So far** = until now. We use **yet** to show that we are expecting something to happen. We use yet in **questions** and **negative** sentences however so far is used in positive.

- Has it stopped raining **yet**?
- I've written the email, but I haven't sent it **yet**.
- He has scored 50 runs **so far**.

➤ You can use the present perfect for new or recent happenings:

- **I've repaired** the washing machine. It's working OK now.
- "Sarah **has secured** the first position." "That's great news."

State Verbs in Present Perfect

Some verbs show a **state** (not an action). These include:

1. **"Have/has been"** – Talking about a condition or place

- **Example: I have been sick for two days.** (I started feeling sick in the past and I'm still sick now.)
- **Example: She has been at school since morning.** (She came to school earlier and is still there.)

2. **"Have/has had"** – Talking about possession or experience

- **Example: I have had this book for a year.** (I got the book a year ago and I still have it.)
- **Example: He has had a pet dog since he was a baby.** (He got a dog in the past and still has it.)

3. **"Have known"** – Talking about knowledge or relationships

- **Example: I have known my best friend since kindergarten.** (I met my friend in the past and still know them.)
- **Example: She has known this secret for a long time.** (She learned the secret earlier and still knows it.)

Exercise: 1

Fill in the blanks with the correct form of "have been," "have had," or "have known."

1. I _____ in this school for three years.
2. She _____ this teddy bear since she was a baby.
3. They _____ each other since first grade.
4. We _____ best friends for a long time.
5. He _____ a cold for two days.
6. My parents _____ our neighbor for ten years.
7. You _____ very kind to me.
8. She _____ the same teacher since last year.
9. We _____ this song for many months.
10. I _____ tired all day.

Exercise: 2

Are the underlined parts of these sentences OK? Correct them where necessary.

1. I've lost my key. I can't find it anywhere.

OK

2. Have you eaten a lot of sweets when you were a child?

Did you eat

3. I've bought a new car. You must come and see it.

4. I've bought a new car last week.

5. Where have you been yesterday evening?

6. Maria has left school in 1999.

7. I'm looking for Mike. Have you seen him?

8. "Have you been to Paris?" "Yes, many times."

9. I'm very hungry. I haven't eaten much today.

10. When has this bridge been built?

Exercise: 3

Put the verb into the correct form, present perfect or past simple.

1. I _____ (I / not / be) to Canada, but I'd like to go there.

2. Ali and Sarah _____ (arrive) about ten minutes ago.

3. I'm tired. _____ (I / not / sleep) well last night.

4. _____ (There / be) a bus drivers' strike last week, so _____ (there / be) no buses.

5. Edward _____ (work) in a bank for 15 years. Then _____ (he / give) it up. Now he works as a gardener.

6. Mary lives in Dublin. _____ (She / live) there all her life.

7. My grandfather _____ (die) before I was born. _____ (I / never / meet) him.

8. I don't know Sofia's brother. _____ (I / never / meet) him.

Exercise: 4

Write sentences about yourself using the ideas in brackets.

1. (something you haven't done today)

I haven't eaten any fruit today.

2. (something you haven't done today)

3. (something you didn't do yesterday)

4. (something you did yesterday evening)

5. (something you haven't done recently)

6. (something you've done a lot recently)

Exercise: 5

Read the situations and complete the sentences using the present perfect. Choose from these verbs:

~~lose~~ grow disappear shrink increase improve
stop break

1. Zain is looking for his key. He can't find it.

Zain *has lost his key.*

2. Maria's English wasn't very good. Now it is better.

Her English _____

3. My bag was here, but it isn't here anymore.

My bag _____

4. Rida can't walk and her leg is in plaster.

Rida _____

5. Last week the bus fare was Rs. 100. Now it is Rs. 120.

The bus fare _____

6. Ali didn't have a beard before. Now he has a beard.

Ali _____

7. It was raining ten minutes ago. It isn't raining now.

It _____

8. I washed my sweater, and now it's too small for me.

My sweater _____

Exercise: 6

Put in been or gone.

1. My parents are on holiday. They've gone to Italy.

2. Hello! I've just _____ to the shops. I've bought lots of things.

3. Zain has just _____ out. He'll be back in about an hour.

4. Saba isn't here at the moment. I Don't know where she's _____.

5. You're very late. Where have you _____?

Exercise: 7

Read the situations and write sentences with just, already, or yet.

1. After lunch you go to see a friend at her house. She says, "Would you like something to eat?"

You say: No, thank you. I've just had lunch. (have lunch)

2. Zain goes out. Five minutes later, the phone rings and the caller says, "Can I speak to Zain?"

You say: I'm afraid _____ (go out)

3. You are eating in a restaurant. The waiter thinks you have finished and starts to take your plate away.

You say: Wait a minute! _____ (not / finish)

4. You plan to eat at a restaurant tonight. You phone to reserve a table.

Later your friend says, "Shall I phone to reserve a table?" You say: No,
_____ (do it)

5. You know that Rida is looking for a place to live. Perhaps she has been successful.

You ask her _____ (find)

6. You are still thinking about where to go for your holiday. A friend asks, "Where are you going?"

You say: _____ (not / decide)

7. Sofia went out, but a few minutes ago she returned. Somebody asks, "Is Sofia still out?"

You say: No, _____ (come back)

7

PRESENT PERFECT 2 (I HAVE DONE)

➤ In the following examples , the speakers are talking about a period that **continues until now** (been to, recently, in the last few days, so far, since I arrived etc.):

- **Have** you **travelled** a lot, Sarah?
- **I've been** to China twice.
- **I've** never **been to** Canada. Have you **been** there?
- **Have** you **heard** anything from Ali **recently**?
- **I've met** a lot of people **in the last few days**.
- Everything is going well. There **haven't been** any problems **so far**.
- The weather is bad here. It's (= It **has**) **rained** every day **since I arrived**. (= from when I arrived until now)
- It's good to see you again. We **haven't seen** each other **for a long time**.

➤ In the same way we use the present perfect with **today, this evening, this year etc. when these periods are not finished at the time of speaking**:

- **I've drunk** four cups of coffee **today**.
- **Have** you **had** a holiday **this year**?
- I **haven't seen** Zain **this morning**. **Have** you?

Exercise: 1

You ask people about things they have done. Write questions with ever.

1. (ride / horse?) Have you ever ridden a horse?
2. (be / California?) **Have** _____
3. (run / marathon?) _____
4. (speak / famous person?) _____
5. (visit / most beautiful place?) _____

Exercise: 2

Write four sentences about yourself. Use I haven't and choose from the boxes.

~~used a computer~~
read a book

travelled by bus
eaten any fruit

been to the cinema
lost anything

1. I haven't used a computer today.
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

8

PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS AND PRESENT PERFECT (I HAVE BEEN DOING AND I HAVE DONE)

A) Compare these two situations:

"I've been painting my bedroom for an hour."

There is paint on Sofia's clothes.
She **has been painting** her bedroom.



has been painting is the present perfect continuous.
We are thinking of the activity. It does not matter whether it has been

finished or not. In this example, the activity (painting the bedroom) has not been finished.



"I've painted my bedroom."

The bedroom was green. Now it is yellow.
She **has painted** her bedroom.

has painted is the present perfect simple.

Here, the important thing is that something has been finished.
"She has painted" is a completed action. We are thinking about the **result** of the activity (the painted bedroom), not the activity itself.

B) Compare these examples:

- My hands are very dirty. I've been **repairing** my bike.
- Zain **has been eating** too much recently. He should eat less.
- It's nice to see you again. What **have you been doing** since we last met?
- Where have you been? **Have you been playing** tennis?
- My bike is OK again now. I've **repaired** it. (= I've finished repairing it)
- Somebody **has eaten** all the chocolates. The box is empty.
- Where's the book I gave you? What **have you done** with it?
- Have you ever **played** tennis?

C) We use the continuous to say **how long** (for something that is still happening):

- How **long have you been reading** that book?
- Hania is writing emails. She's **been writing** emails all morning.
- They've **been playing** tennis since 2 o'clock.
- I'm learning Arabic, but I **haven't been learning** it very long.

D) We use **for** and **since** to say how long something has been happening.

We use **for** + a period of time:

- We've been waiting **for two hours**.

two hours	20 minutes	five days	a long time
six months	50 years	a week	ages years

- Saba has been working here **for six months**. (not since six months)
- I haven't seen Zain **for three days**.

We use **since** + the start of a period:

- We've been waiting **since 8 o'clock**.

8 o'clock

Monday

12 May

April

2001

Eid

lunchtime

we arrived,

- Saba has been working here **since April**. (= from April until now)
- I haven't seen Zain **since Monday**.
- She hasn't improved **since** we met her last.

E) We say:

it's (= it is) or
it's been (= it has been)

a long time
six months (etc.)

since something
happened

- It's **two years since** I last saw Zain. or It's **been two years since** ...
(= I haven't seen Zain for two years)
- It's **ages since** we went to the cinema. or It's **been ages since** ...
(= We haven't been to the cinema for ages)
- **How long is it since** Mrs. Hill died? or **How long has it been since** ...
(= when did she die?)

Exercise: 1

What have these people been doing or what has been happening?



1. *It's been raining.*



2. She



3. They



4. He

Exercise: 2

Write a question for each situation.

1. You meet Zain as he is leaving the swimming pool.

You say: Hi, Zain. (you / swim?)

Have you been swimming?

2. You have arrived a little late to meet Ali who is waiting for you.

You say: I'm sorry I'm late, Ali. (you / wait / long?)

3. Sarah's little boy comes into the house with a very dirty face and dirty hands.

His mother says: Why are you so dirty? (what / you / do?)

4. You are in a shop and see Sarah. You didn't know she worked there.

You say: Hi, Sarah. (how long / you / work / here?)

5. A friend tells you about his job – he sells phones.

You say: You sell phones? (how long / you / do / that?)

Exercise: 3

Read the situation and complete the sentences. Use the verbs in brackets.

1. Zain started reading a book two hours ago. He is still reading it and now he is on page 53. *He has been reading* for two hours. (read) *He has read* 53 pages so far. (read)

2. Ayesha is from Australia. She is travelling round Europe. She began her trip three months ago. She _____

_____ for three months. (travel) She _____

_____ six countries so

far. (visit)

3. Ali is a tennis player. He began playing tennis when he was 10 years old. This year he won the national championship again – for the fourth time.

_____ the national championship four times. (win) _____
_____ since he was ten. (play)

4. When they left college, Rida and Sofia started making films together. They still make films. They _____

_____ films since they left college. (make) _____
_____ five films since they left college. (make)

Exercise: 4

Ask questions using the words in brackets. Use the present perfect (have / has done) or present perfect continuous (have / has been doing).

1. You have a friend who is learning Arabic.

You ask: (how long / learn / Arabic?)

How long have you been learning Arabic?

2. You have just arrived to meet a friend. She is waiting for you.

You ask: (wait / long?)

Have _____

3. You see somebody fishing by the river.

You ask: (catch / any fish?)

4. Some friends of yours are having a party next week.

You ask: (how many people / invite?)

5. A friend of yours is a teacher.

You ask: (how long / teach?)

6. You meet somebody who is a writer.

You ask: (how many books / write?)

(how long / write / books?)

7. A friend of yours is saving money to go on a world trip.

You ask: (how long / save?)

(how much money / save?)

Exercise: 5

Read the situations and write questions using the words in brackets.

1. A friend tells you that Ali is in hospital.

You ask him: (how long / Ali / hospital?)

How long has Ali been in hospital?

2. You know that Sarah is a good friend of Sofia's.

You ask Sarah: (how long / you / know / Sofia?)

3. Your friend's sister went to Australia some time ago and she's still there.

You ask your friend: (how long / sister / in Australia?)

4. You meet a woman who tells you that she teaches English.

You ask her: (how long / you / teach / English?)

5. Zain always wears the same jacket. It's very old.

You ask him: (how long / you / have / that jacket?)

6. You are talking to a friend about Zain, who now works at the airport.

You ask your friend: (how long / Zain / work / airport?)

7. You meet somebody on a plane. She says that she lives in Chicago.

You ask her: (you / always / live / in Chicago?)

Exercise: 6

Write for or since.

1. It's been raining since lunchtime.

2. Ali has lived in Brazil _____ ten years.

3. I'm tired of waiting. We've been sitting here _____ an hour.

4. Sami has been looking for a job _____ he left school.

5. I haven't been to a party _____ ages.

6. I wonder where Zain is. I haven't seen him _____ last week.

7. Sarah is away on holiday. She's been away _____ Friday.

8. The weather is dry. It hasn't rained _____ a few weeks.